County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Hilton Head Island Branch Library
Beach City Road
Hilton Head Island, SC 29926

Monday, January 26, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/373212

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:19 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard - Virtual
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson - Virtual
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Vice-Chair Tabernik led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Vice-Chair Tabernik stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to amend the agenda to remove from the Consent Agenda item 2. Reappointments to the Bluffton Township Fire District for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion failed 3:8.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Member Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 9:2.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Chair Howard to approve the minutes from Caucus and Council January 12,2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

6. Administrators Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/373212

7. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken.

8. Liaison and Committee Reports

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Lawson to vacate the suspension of Mr. Rick Krob from his position as a commissioner on the town Bluffton Township Fire District Board of Commissioners which was put in place April 28, 2025, since a new fire chief has been appointed for the Bluffton Township Fire District and that vacation of the suspension shall take place immediately.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment. The motion failed 5:6.

9. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the approval of a change order to O'Quinn Marine Construction Inc for the Melrose Dock Repairs for additional work ($161,315).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Executive Committee

1. Appointment and Reappointments to the Airports Board for a two-year term with the expiration date of February 2028.

    - Eli Roth - Term to be served: 1st (Appointed by the Town of Hilton Head)
    - Mark Bailey - Term to be served: 4th
    - Rich Sells - Term to be served: 2nd
    - James Starne s- Term to be served: 2nd

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve the appointment and reappointment to the Airports Board for a two-year term with the expiration date of February 2028.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

2. Reappointments to the Bluffton Township Fire District for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

    - Rick Krob - Term to be served: 3rd
    - Joseph Paolo - Term to be served: 4th

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the reappointments to the Bluffton Township Fire District for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment. The motion failed 8:3.

3. Reappointment to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

    - James Atkins - Term to be Served: 6th

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the reappointment to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

4. Reappointments to the Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

    - Ford Bartholow - Term to be served: 2nd
    - Jean Fruh - Term to be served: 3rd
    - Brenda McFee - Term to be served: 2nd
    - Christopher Campbell - Term to be served: 4th
    - Pamela Floyd - Term to be served: 4th

- Eugene Zapfel - Term to be served: 2nd

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointment to the Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

5. Reappointments to the Parks and Recreation Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

    - Christian Kata - Term to be served: 2nd
    - Ariel Perry - Term to be served: 2nd

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the reappointments to the Parks and Recreation Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

6. Reappointments to the Stormwater Management Utility Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

    - Dennis Ross - Term to be served: 2nd
    - Ronald Buchanan - Term to be served: 2nd
    - Steven Andrews - Term to be served: 2nd

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointments to the Stormwater Management Utility Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

7. Reappointment to the Accommodations Tax (2% State) Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

    - Anita Singleton-Prather - Term to be served: 5th

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Chair Howard to approve the reappointment to the Accommodations Tax (2% State) Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover,

Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

8. Reappointments to the Planning Commission for a three-year term with an expiration date of February 2029.

    - Jonathan Henney - Term to be served: 2nd
    - Gail Murray - Term to be served: 3rd
    - Dennis Ross - Term to be served: 2nd
    - Glenn Miller Jr. - Term to be served 2nd

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointments to the Planning Commission for a three-year term with the expiration date of February 2029.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

9. Reappointment to the Zoning Board of Appeals for a three-year term with the expiration date of February 2029.

    - Kevin Mack - Term to be served: 7th

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the reappointment to the Zoning Board of Appeals for a three-year term with the expiration date of February 2029.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. Items Originating from Public Facilities Committee

1. Approval of a change order to O'Quinn Marine Construction Inc for the Melrose Dock Repairs for additional work ($161,315)

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

10. Agenda Item

a. Replacement of the Welcome to Beaufort County sign along US 278 by Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Board.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Reitz to approve sign #1 with modification to add the verbiage "Welcome to" to the sign.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Brown, and Council Member Cunningham. The motion passed 8:3.

b. In accordance with Resolution 2025/70, approval of Transportation Advisory Committee (TAC) Appointments

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member McElynn to approve in accordance with Resolution 2025/70 the approval of Transportation Advisory Committee (TAC) appointments.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

11. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2025/53: An Ordinance Authorizing the Acceptance and Possible Eminent Domain Associated with a Drainage Easement located in Rivers End Subdivision Identified as Open Area in Plat Book 59 at page 118.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on December 8, 2025 - 9:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on January 12, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve third reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/53.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

12. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/01: An Ordinance amending the Zoning Map for 231.58 Acres (R100 025 000 0084 0000, R100 025 000 0110 0000, R100 020 000 047A 0000, R100 026 00A 0260 0000, R100 026 00A 0261 0000, R300 028 000 0016 0000, R300 028 000 016A 0000, R300 015 000 076B 0000, R100 033 00A 0022 0000, R600 009 000 0030 0000, R600 013 000 0048 0000, R600 009 000 0003 0000, R600 005 000 004D 0000, R600 021 000 0078 0000, R600 029 000 0054 0000, R600 021 000 0819 0000) from S1, T2R, T3HN, T4HC, C4CCMU, and C5RCMU to T1NP.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on November 3, 2025 - 6:2
The vote at First Reading and Public Hearing on January 12, 2026 - 7:4
At their October 6 meeting, the Planning Commission voted unanimously (9:0) to recommend approval.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Chair Howard to approve the second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/01 for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals and policies of the Development Code; it is not in conflict with provisions of the Development Code or our Code of Ordinances; it does address a demonstrated community need; it is required by changed conditions; it is compatible with existing and proposed use of land surrounding this land; it would not adversely affect nearby land; it would result in adverse impact on the natural environment (water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment); and it would result in development that is adequately served by public facilities (streets, potable water, sewer, stormwater management, solid waste collection and disposal, schools, parks, police, fire, emergency medical facilities).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn and Council Member Reitz. The motion failed 4:7.

13. Ordinances for First Reading

a. 2026/02: An Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator to Execute the Necessary Documents and Provide Funding for the Purchase of Real Property Located at 1451 Ribaut Road (TMS No. R110 009 000 0031 0000) from Drayton-Parker Companies LLC in the amount of $700,000 plus closing costs

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on January 20, 2026 - 9:0

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the first reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/02.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

14. Resolutions

a. 2026/01: A Resolution of Beaufort County Council adopting a step pay scale, amending section 4.1 of the Beaufort County Personnel Handbook (Compensation Plan), and authorizing implementation with a retroactive effective date.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/01.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

15. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: February 9, 2026